

SOP-LOTO-400: Lockout/Tagout Procedure

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

This procedure establishes requirements for the control of hazardous energy during maintenance and servicing of equipment, ensuring machines and processes are properly shut down and isolated before work begins. It applies to all electrical, mechanical, hydraulic, pneumatic, chemical, and thermal energy sources.

Section 2. Energy Isolation Requirements

Clause 2.1 — All energy-isolating devices (breakers, valves, disconnects) shall be identified on an equipment-specific Lockout/Tagout Procedure Sheet before work begins. Equipment without a documented procedure sheet shall not be worked on until one is created by the responsible engineer.

Clause 2.2 — Each authorized employee performing work shall apply their own personal lock and tag to every identified isolation point. Group lockout using a lock box is permitted only when more than one crew is working on the same equipment, per Section 4.

Clause 2.3 — After isolation, stored energy (residual pressure, capacitor charge, spring tension, suspended loads) shall be dissipated or restrained before work begins.

Clause 2.4 — A zero-energy verification check shall be performed and documented by attempting to start or actuate the equipment through normal operating controls before work begins. The controls shall then be returned to the off position.

Section 3. Lock and Tag Standards

Step 3.1 — Locks shall be uniquely keyed to the individual employee; no two employees shall share a key, and no master key shall exist for personal locks used in LOTO application.

Step 3.2 — Tags shall include the employee name, date, and reason for lockout, and shall be attached at the same point as the lock. A tag alone, without a lock, is only acceptable where the isolating device is not capable of being locked, and requires additional verification per Step 2.4.

Step 3.3 — Locks and tags shall only be removed by the employee who applied them. Removal by another person requires the procedure in Section 5 (Lock Removal by Others).

Section 4. Group Lockout

Clause 4.1 — For group lockout, the primary authorized employee shall place a group lockout device on each isolation point, and each individual crew member shall place their personal lock on the group lock box.

Clause 4.2 — No crew member's lock shall be removed from the lock box until that individual has confirmed they are clear of the equipment and no longer performing work.

Clause 4.3 — A shift change during an active group lockout requires the incoming crew to apply their own locks before the outgoing crew removes theirs, ensuring continuous isolation.

Section 5. Lock Removal by Others

Step 5.1 — If an authorized employee is unavailable to remove their own lock (e.g., left the site without removing it), the Area Supervisor may authorize removal only after verifying the employee cannot be reached and confirming through a documented inspection that it is safe to do so.

Step 5.2 — The employee whose lock was removed shall be informed before they resume work at the site, and the incident shall be logged in the LOTO Exception

Register.

Section 6. Periodic Inspection and Training

Clause 6.1 — LOTO procedures shall be audited annually by the HSE Department, including a physical inspection of at least 10 percent of active lockout points during the audit period.

Clause 6.2 — All authorized employees shall be retrained if an audit identifies a procedural violation, if a new energy source is introduced to existing equipment, or at a minimum every 24 months.

Clause 6.3 — Any energy-control incident, including unexpected equipment start-up during lockout, shall be reported immediately and investigated as a serious near-miss regardless of whether injury occurred.